

Harvested Flavour

Hakunamatata · Muldersdrift

Field Record

Role	Design & Dev
Sector	Restaurant
Origin	Cold pitch
Built by	Mongezi Mabuza

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The Plot

BRIEF & CONTEXT

Harvested Flavour, a restaurant at Hakunamatata in Muldersdrift, had no functioning web presence — no site a diner could land on to check the menu, hours, or how to get there before making the trip out. That gap is the opening: a farm-adjacent, destination-style restaurant with nowhere online that actually represented it.

No brief came from the client, because at this stage there was no client — this was scouted and built speculatively, ahead of any contact, as part of an ongoing pipeline targeting small Johannesburg and Pretoria-area businesses without a web presence.

The pitch is the site itself. Show a working demo before asking for a meeting, a budget, or a yes.

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The Planting

APPROACH & BUILD

Built to a two-tier spec from the outset, so the demo itself can carry the upsell conversation rather than needing a separate sales pitch. The frontend is deliberately plain: vanilla HTML, CSS, and JS — fast to build, easy to hand off, and with nothing in the stack that would slow a client's next developer down if they ever needed to make a change without me.

The upgrade tier adds a real backend: an Express server handling booking submissions, SQLite for storage, and Nodemailer wired up so a booking actually reaches the restaurant's inbox and the guest gets a confirmation — not a form that just looks like it works.

HTML / CSS / JS

Node.js + Express

SQLite (node:sqlite)

Nodemailer

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The Yield

OFFER STRUCTURE

Priced as a straightforward, honest two-tier offer — no vague “custom quote,” so a small-business owner can look at it once and know exactly what they’d be paying for.

TIER 1 — STATIC

R3,500

- Home, menu, about, location & hours, contact
- Fully responsive, mobile-first
- No backend — content edits handled by me or handed off

DEMO BUILT TO THIS SPEC

TIER 2 — STATIC + BOOKING

R5,000

- Everything in Tier 1
- Live booking form, backed by a real database
- Automatic email notification + guest confirmation

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The Harvest

OUTCOME & WHAT IT PROVES

The finished demo was hosted live and sent directly to the restaurant via Instagram DM — the same channel most small businesses in this space actually use to run themselves. Whatever the response, the build itself is proof of a repeatable process: scout a business with no site, build a working demo to a fixed two-tier spec, and pitch with the thing itself instead of a proposal document.

Harvested Flavour slots into a pipeline that already includes Cheese Louise Social Club, SOUT, Kalili Events, and others — same shape, same stack discipline, applied to a new business each time.

DISCOVERY	Confirm no existing site; scope the restaurant’s identity and content needs
BUILD	Frontend + Tier 2 backend built to full spec, tested end to end
PITCH	Live demo link sent directly to the business via Instagram DM